

Important information. Please read carefully.

XEPA CHLORAMPHENICOL

Eye Drops 0.5% w/v

COMPOSITION

Each 5ml contains Chloramphenicol 0.5% w/v.
Benzalkonium Chloride 0.01% w/v as preservative.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

Chloramphenicol is a broad spectrum antibiotic with bacteriostatic activity and is effective against a wide range of gram negative and gram-positive organisms including *Haemophilus influenzae*, *Streptococcus pneumoniae*, *Staphylococcus aureus*, *Streptococcus viridans*, *Moraxella* species and *Enterobacteriaceae*, the main pathogens responsible for acute bacterial conjunctivitis. Chloramphenicol exerts its antibacterial effect by reversibly binding to bacterial ribosomes thereby inhibiting bacterial protein synthesis.

PHARMACOKINETICS

Evidence suggests that chloramphenicol is absorbed systemically via topical ocular administration. Any chloramphenicol that is absorbed will be widely distributed in the body tissues and fluids. It is found in cerebrospinal fluid, is secreted in saliva, with the highest concentrations occurring in the kidneys and liver.

Chloramphenicol also diffuses across the placenta into the foetal circulation and into breast milk. Chloramphenicol is excreted chiefly in the urine as the glucuronide with small amounts being excreted via the bile and faeces. It has a reported half-life of 1.5 to 5 hours which is increased in patients with liver impairment and neonates to between 24 and 28 hours in the latter.

INDICATIONS

Xepa Chloramphenicol is indicated for use as a topical antibacterial in the treatment of superficial ocular infections.

DOSAGE AND ADMINISTRATION

For eye application only.

Adults (including the elderly) and children

One to two drops applied topically to each affected eye up to six times daily or more frequently if required. (Severe infections may require one to two drops every fifteen to twenty minutes initially, reducing the frequency of instillation gradually as the infection is controlled).

CONTRAINDICATIONS

- Contraindicated in patients with known hypersensitivity to Chloramphenicol.
- Myelosuppression during previous exposure to chloramphenicol.
- Known personal or family history of blood dyscrasias including aplastic anaemia

WARNINGS AND PRECAUTIONS

- Chloramphenicol is absorbed systemically from the eye and toxicity has been reported following chronic exposure.
- Bone marrow hypoplasia, including aplastic anaemia and death, has been reported following topical use of chloramphenicol. Whilst the hazard is a rare one, it should be borne in mind when assessing the benefits expected from the use of the compound.
- Where Xepa Chloramphenicol eye drops are used on a long term or intermittent basis, it may be advisable to perform a routine blood profile before therapy and at appropriate intervals thereafter to detect any haemopoietic abnormalities.
- In severe infections topical use of chloramphenicol should be supplemented with appropriate systemic treatment.
- Prolonged use should be avoided as it may increase the likelihood of sensitisation and the emergence of resistant organisms.
- If any new infection appears during the treatment, the antibiotic should be discontinued and appropriate measures taken.
- Xepa Chloramphenicol should be reserved for use only in infections for which it is specifically indicated.
- Xepa Chloramphenicol Eye Drops does not provide adequate coverage against *Pseudomonas aeruginosa* and *Serratia marcescens*.
- Do not use for more than 5 days without consulting a doctor.
- Medical advice should be sought if there is no improvement in the condition after 2 days or if symptoms worsen at any time.
- Patients should be referred to their doctor if any of the following apply:
Disturbed vision, Severe pain within the eye, Photophobia, Eye inflammation associated with a rash on the scalp or face, The eye looks cloudy, The pupil looks unusual and Suspected foreign body in the eye.
- Patients should also be referred to their doctor if any of the following in his/her medical history apply:
Previous conjunctivitis in the recent past, Glaucoma, Dry eye syndrome, Eye surgery or laser treatment in the last 6 months, Eye injury, Current use of other eye drops or eye ointment and Contact lens use.
- Soft contact lenses should not be worn during treatment with Xepa Chloramphenicol eye drops due to absorption of the preservative onto the lens which may cause damage to the lens. It is recommended that all types of contact lenses be avoided during ocular infections.

DRUG INTERACTIONS

The concomitant administration of Xepa Chloramphenicol with other drugs liable to depress bone marrow function should be avoided.

PREGNANCY AND LACTATION

Xepa Chloramphenicol may be absorbed systemically following the use of eye drops and may cross the placenta and appear in breast milk. Therefore this product is not recommended for use during pregnancy and lactation.

SIDE EFFECTS

- Eye disorders:
Transient irritation, burning, stinging and sensitivity reactions such as itching and dermatitis.
- Immune System Disorders:
Hypersensitivity reactions including angioedema, anaphylaxis, urticaria, fever, vesicular and maculopapular dermatitis.
- Blood and lymphatic system disorders:
Bone marrow depression and rarely aplastic anaemia has been reported following topical use of chloramphenicol. Whilst the hazard is a rare one, it should be borne in mind when assessing the benefits expected from the use of this compound.

SYMPTOMS AND TREATMENT FOR OVERDOSAGE

Accidental ingestion of the drops is unlikely to cause systemic toxicity due to the low content of the antibiotic in the product. If irritation, pain, swelling, lacrimation or photophobia occur after undesired eye contact, the exposed eye(s) should be irrigated for at least 15 minutes. If symptoms persist after this, an ophthalmological examination should be considered.

EFFECTS ON ABILITY TO DRIVE AND USE MACHINE

Transient blurring of vision may occur immediately after use and driving or using machinery should not occur until the vision is clear.

SHELF-LIFE

The expiry date is indicated on the packaging.

STORAGE CONDITION

Store in refrigerator between 2-8°C. Do not freeze. Discard 4 weeks after first opening.

PRODUCT DESCRIPTION

Sterile, buffered, preserved aqueous ophthalmic solution in pack of 5ml.

KEEP OUT OF REACH OF CHILDREN/ JAUHI DARI KANAK-KANAK

For further information, please consult your pharmacist or physician.

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Manufacturer and Product Registration Holder

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